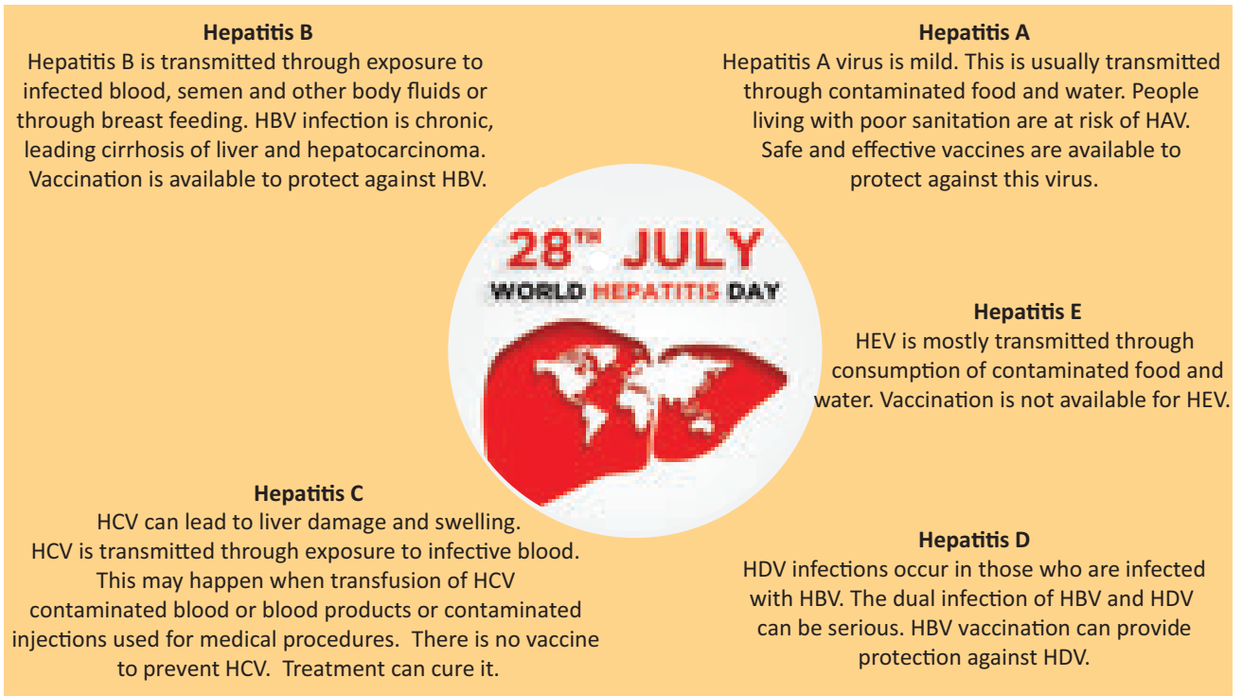


Fig 8.4 HEPATITIS VIRUSES

Goals for dietary treatment

- To provide adequate nutrition to the patient
- To avoid malnutrition
- To relieve symptoms of the disease
- To support the regeneration of liver tissues
- To prevent progression of the disease

Dietary Principle

A diet which has adequate calorie, high protein, high carbohydrate, low fat, adequate fibre and adequate fluid diet is prescribed for the patient. Small frequent meals are better tolerated than three large meals.

Diet therapy for Hepatitis

Energy

Energy intake can be increased gradually based on the tolerance of the patient. At initial stage, patient may not be able to eat enough due to anorexia. Gradually the energy intake can be increased to 1600-2000 kcal per day. This is to prevent endogenous breakdown of protein.

Protein

High protein diet promotes regeneration of the liver. Around 1.5g to 2g per kg body weight is recommended. Good quality protein is preferred for the patient. If the patient has jaundice, 40-60 grams of protein can be given. In case of hepatic coma, protein intake should be withheld till condition improves.

Fat

Fat digestion and absorption is impaired in hepatitis. Low fat diet is preferred for the patient with hepatitis. Easily digested fats like medium chain triglycerides or emulsified fats such as milk, butter, cream, eggs should be given. For a patient with jaundice, 20-30 grams of fat per day can be given.

Activity : 6

Match the causes for the Hepatitis!

Viral hepatitis	-	Autoimmune
Alcoholic Hepatitis	-	Hepatitis virus
Chronic Hepatitis	-	Alcohol

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